

NICHOLAS EDWARDS

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EDUCATION

- University of Vienna**, PhD Computer Science 2025–present
(Supervisor: Sebastian Schuster)
- University of Edinburgh**, MSc Speech & Language Processing 2021–2022
Result: Distinction
- University of Cambridge**, BA Linguistics 2018–2021
Result: First Class

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- University College London/Google DeepMind** July 2025–September 2025
Course Developer (contractor) London, UK
- Contributed to the development of Google DeepMind’s [AI Research Foundations course](#)
 - Developed the majority of educational materials, including coding lab notebooks and articles, for Course 7 (Accelerate Your Model)
 - Assisted in developing coding lab notebooks for Course 3 (Design And Train Neural Networks)
- University College London** September 2024–August 2025
Research Assistant London, UK
- Investigated LLMs as autonomous research agents in collaboration with Boston University, leading to RExBench (ACL 2026; co-first author), a benchmark evaluating whether coding agents can implement novel AI research extensions.
 - Supervisors: Sebastian Schuster (UCL) & Najoung Kim (Boston University)
- Cohere** January 2024–August 2025
Senior Data Quality Specialist – RAG Data Science (contractor) London, UK
- Curated high-quality human-annotated training data to improve the data science-related capabilities of Cohere’s LLMs.
 - Combined skills in coding (Python, SQL) and writing to create training examples encompassing database exploration and understanding.
- Sense Street** September 2022–September 2023
NLP Data Scientist London, UK
- Worked on all aspects of the machine learning pipeline, from data annotation through to model finetuning, working with state-of-the-art language models for novel classification and information extraction tasks on trader conversations in the financial domain.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- Harbor Adapters and Harbor-Index: Infrastructure and a Curated Meta-Dataset for Large-Scale Agentic Evaluation**
Lin, S., ..., **Edwards, N.**, ..., Schmidt, L., & Shaw, A.
Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems, Evaluations & Datasets Track (NeurIPS 2026)

2. Ask or Assume? Uncertainty-Aware Clarification-Seeking in Coding Agents

Edwards, N., & Schuster, S.

Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EMNLP 2026)

3. RExBench: Can coding agents autonomously implement AI research extensions?

Edwards, N.^{*}, Lee, Y.^{*}, Mao, Y. A., Qin, Y., Schuster, S.[†], & Kim, N.[†]

Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL 2026)

^{*}Equal contribution. [†]Equal senior authorship.

4. Anaphoric Structure Emerges Between Neural Networks

Edwards, N., Rohde, H., & Coxe-Conklin, H.

Proceedings of the 45th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2023)

Preprints & Under Review

Pr. From Models to Systems: A Survey of Explainability for Tool-Augmented Language Models and AI Agents

Roth, B., Edwards, N., Hong, P., Schoenegger, L., & Schuster, S.

University of Vienna (preprint), 2026

PRESENTATIONS

Ask or Assume? Uncertainty-Aware Clarification-Seeking in Coding Agents

October 2026

Poster Presentations (upcoming), Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP; Findings) & REALM Workshop, Budapest

RExBench: Can coding agents autonomously implement AI research extensions?

July 2026

Poster Presentation, Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), San Diego

RExBench: Can coding agents autonomously implement AI research extensions?

September 2025

Invited Talk, Prof. Ludwig Schmidt's Research Group, Stanford/UW

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Volunteer: EMNLP 2026

Conference Reviewer: NeurIPS 2026 Evaluations & Datasets Track

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages

Python, SQL, Bash, R

Libraries

PyTorch, vLLM, Transformers, Pandas, scikit-learn

Agentic Tools

OpenHands, Harbor

Infrastructure

Git, Docker, Modal, AWS, Slurm, Apptainer

OTHER SKILLS

Natural Languages

English (native), Russian (fluent), German (advanced), French (intermediate)